REFLECTION

كُلَّ يَوْمٍ هُوَ فِي شَأْنٍ

The Heavens Through the Webb Telescope

Ar-Rahman 55:29

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REFLECTION

The Heavens Through the Webb Telescope

Surah Ar-Rahman and Surah Al-Mulk

In 2022 the James Webb Space Telescope sent back its first pictures. One showed the "Cosmic Cliffs" of the Carina Nebula, about 7,600 light-years away, where the tallest peaks of gas and dust are about 7 light-years high and new stars are being born inside them. Another showed the galaxy NGC 7496, some 24 million light-years away, with glowing lanes of dust and gas where stars are forming.

Every day He is at work

In Surah Ar-Rahman (55:29):

يَسْأَلُهُ مَن فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ ۚ كُلَّ يَوْمٍ هُوَ فِي شَأْنٍ ﴿٢٩﴾

"Everyone in the heavens and the earth asks of Him. Every day He is at some work."

Stars being born in clouds trillions of miles tall: this is some of that work, happening right now, by His command كُن فَيَكُونُ "Be, and it is".

Look again

In Surah Al-Mulk (67:3–4):

الَّذِي خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَاوَاتٍ طِبَاقًا ۖ مَّا تَرَىٰ فِي خَلْقِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ مِن تَفَاوُتٍ ۖ فَارْجِعِ الْبَصَرَ هَلْ تَرَىٰ مِن فُطُورٍ ﴿٣﴾ ثُمَّ ارْجِعِ الْبَصَرَ كَرَّتَيْنِ يَنقَلِبْ إِلَيْكَ الْبَصَرُ خَاسِئًا وَهُوَ حَسِيرٌ ﴿٤﴾

"He created seven heavens in layers. You will see no flaw in the creation of the Most Merciful. Look again: do you see any cracks? Then look again and again; your sight will come back to you humbled and tired."

We now look with telescopes a million times sharper than the eye, and the challenge still stands. Read the Qur'an in Arabic and understand it, and see its wonders for yourself.

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